

# AN INDIAN IMPRINT

India plays muse and Pakistan comes calling as Lakme Fashion Week Spring Summer 2008 commences in Mumbai

■ By Kimi Dangor

**S**oaring temperatures in Mumbai might just be what the designers need to create a perfect sizzling set-up for the Lakme Fashion week (LFW) Spring Summer 2008 (October 13 to 17). And looking at the collections set to be modelled at the National Centre for Performing Arts, the Week promises to have a distinct subcontinental flavour.

If you are looking for some Indian influence you need not peek into the style files of Jean Paul Gaultier and Alexander McQueen, because after a few seasons spent traversing the globe, and glancing into African safaris, and Oriental and Occidental odysseys, Indian designers have found inspiration at home. So, while the white dresses, cool cottons, floral fiestas, sporty styles and vibrant colours will rule the LFW ramp too, you are unlikely to escape the distinct desi touch.

The season marks the return of Sabyasachi Mukherjee to the ramp. The Kolkata designer, hitherto perceived to be kowtowing to Albert Morris of Brown's—a permanent fixture in his front row—goes Indian this time, presenting an ethnic couture line along with an international prêt collection at two separate shows. Following in the wake are younger labels like Ahmedabad-based Shyamal & Bhumika, Anupama Dayal and Abhishek Dutta who are unapologetically giving vent to their indigenous design sensibilities.

Unusual suspects like Pria Kataria Puri of the ostentatious middle eastern muse fame, who will also present a flamboyant Kashmir-infused creation, and Mumbai-based Nikasha Tawadey, who takes a trip back to her roots with her ethnic-look-global-appeal line, are poised to play up



**PRIA KATARIA PURI:** Her collection Kashmir ki Kali draws inspiration from the valley—its antique shawls, hues of Shalimar Garden, off-whites of cherry blossoms and the blues of its lakes.

